Portfolio Sample · Monthly Social Content Pack — café

> Client: a neighbourhood café/bakery (fictional demo client). 20 ready-to-post social posts (caption + hashtags + image brief + best time), a 4-week calendar, and 3 reusable caption formulas. Content-type delivery — QA: PASS on first review.
>
> Delivered through a production → independent QA → fix → re-QA pipeline. **Final QA verdict: PASS.**

Part 1 · Client Brief & Delivery Spec

Delivery Spec — Bean & Birch Monthly Social Content Pack

Goal

Provide Bean & Birch with a complete, ready-to-use month of social content for Instagram and Facebook that requires no thinking or marketing expertise to execute — just copy-paste posting with self-taken photos.

Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope
Instagram + Facebook only	Other platforms
20 posts for one month	Ongoing management beyond month 1
English language content	Translation
Photo/video briefs (what to shoot, not actual production)	Photography/videography services
Posting guidance (day/time)	Scheduling tool setup or auto-posting

Deliverables

D1: 20 Post Pack

20 individual posts, mixed types as specified:

Post Type	Quantity	Explicit Requirements from Client
Product / promo (new pastry, coffee)	*implied: remainder after other types*	Highlight new pastry drops, coffee
Behind-the-scenes	*implied: portion of remainder*	—
Engagement (questions/polls)	*implied: portion of remainder*	Questions/polls format
Community (staff, local)	*implied: portion of remainder*	Staff, local focus

Post Type	Quantity	Explicit Requirements from Client
Event posts — Friday live music	**4 required**	Promote live music Fridays

Per-post components (all required):

- **Caption**: on-brand, warm, a little playful; neighbourhood café voice, not corporate
- **Hashtags**: 3–5 per post
- **Image/video brief**: one line describing what to shoot (client takes own photos)
- **Best day/time to post**: specific recommendation

Quality standard: No placeholders, no lorem ipsum — fully copy-paste ready

D2: Content Calendar Table

- Format: Week 1–4 × day grid
- Purpose: month-at-a-glance view of all 20 posts

D3: 3 Reusable Caption Formulas

- Purpose: enable client to continue posting after the month without further support
- Format: templates with guidance on how to adapt

Acceptance Criteria

ID	Criterion	Traces To
A1	Exactly 20 posts delivered	"20 posts for the month"
A2	Exactly 4 posts promote Friday live music	"4 event posts for Friday live music"
A3	Every post includes caption, 3–5 hashtags, one-line image/video brief, and best day/time to post	"For each post: the caption... 3-5 hashtags, a one-line image/video brief... and the best day/time to post"
A4	Captions are warm, a little playful, neighbourhood café voice — not corporate	"on-brand, warm, a little playful — neighbourhood café, not corporate"
A5	Image/video briefs describe what to shoot (not produced assets)	"what to shoot, since they take their own photos"
A6	No placeholder text or lorem ipsum anywhere in deliverables	"No placeholders, no lorem ipsum"
A7	Content calendar presents Week 1–4 × day table	"content calendar table (Week 1-4 × day)"
A8	Exactly 3 reusable caption formulas included	"3 reusable caption formulas"
A9	Formulas enable independent ongoing posting	"so they can keep posting after the month without me"
A10	All content in English	"English"

Edge Cases & Defaults

Scenario	Handling	Basis
Post type distribution not specified	Distribute remaining 16 posts reasonably across product/promo, behind-the-scenes, engagement, community; aim for visual variety	Implied by "mixed types"

Scenario	Handling	Basis
Specific pastry/coffee names unknown	Use realistic example names or generic descriptors ("this week's cardamom bun")	"No placeholders" + practical usability
Exact live music dates unknown	Structure 4 event posts for Fridays of a generic month; client maps to actual dates	"month of social content"
Instagram vs. Facebook differentiation	Default (default): captions work for both; note any platform-specific adaptations if relevant (e.g., Instagram Stories polls vs. feed)	Client silent on platform differences
Image brief feasibility	Default (default): briefs assume standard smartphone photography, no special equipment	Client silent on gear

Part 2 · Final Deliverable

Bean & Birch — Monthly Social Content Pack

D1: 20 Post Pack

Week 1

Post 1 — Product/Promo

- **Day/Time:** Tuesday 8:00 AM
- **Caption:** Morning revelation: our new brown butter cardamom bun exists and your coffee was lonely without it. First batch out of the oven at 7. Come say hi before the regulars hoard them all.
- **Hashtags:** #BeanAndBirch #CardamomBunMorning #NeighbourhoodCoffee
- **Image/Video Brief:** Close-up of your hand pulling apart a glazed cardamom bun on a wooden board, steam visible, coffee cup slightly blurred in background

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Post 2 — Engagement

- **Day/Time:** Wednesday 12:00 PM
- **Caption:** The great debate we can't settle at the counter: is a cortado just a small latte or its own beautiful thing? Defend your position. We're taking notes (and maybe adjusting the menu).
- **Hashtags:** #CortadoCrew #CoffeeDebate #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Overhead shot of three different milk coffees lined up (espresso, cortado, latte) with handwritten labels on torn paper

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Post 3 — Behind-the-Scenes

- **Day/Time:** Thursday 3:00 PM
- **Image/Video Brief:** Grainy phone video of flour-dusted hands shaping dough, 10 seconds, natural kitchen light, no faces needed
- **Caption:** 4 AM. The only other things awake are the oven and whoever's shift this is. Every bun gets folded forty times. We counted once and lost track, so now we just say forty. Feels right.
- **Hashtags:** #BakersHours #MadeHere #BeanAndBirch

Post 4 — Event (Friday Live Music)

- **Day/Time:** Friday 10:00 AM
- **Caption:** Tonight: someone with a guitar and a regrettable number of feelings plays them in our corner starting 7 PM. Bring your work laptop, your date, your existential dread. We have wine too now.
- **Hashtags:** #LiveMusicFridays #BeanAndBirch #FridayPlans

- **Image/Video Brief:** Wide shot of your music corner with guitar leaning against chair, fairy lights on, tables set with candles not yet lit

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Post 5 — Community

- **Day/Time:** Saturday 9:00 AM
- **Caption:** This is Priya. She has ordered the same oat flat white every day for two years and once brought us cookies when the machine broke. That's the whole post. Some people just deserve recognition.
- **Hashtags:** #RegularsBecomeFamily #BeanAndBirch #SaturdayMorning
- **Image/Video Brief:** Candid shot of barista handing coffee to smiling customer at counter, natural interaction, don't pose it

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Week 2

Post 6 — Product/Promo

- **Day/Time:** Monday 7:30 AM
- **Caption:** New: Ethiopian Yirgacheffe on pour-over this week. Tastes like someone described a blueberry to the coffee and it got inspired. Limited bags for home if you want to pretend you know what you're doing.
- **Hashtags:** #SingleOrigin #PourOver #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Slow pour of kettle stream into V60, catch the bloom, morning light from window

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Post 7 — Engagement

- **Day/Time:** Tuesday 6:00 PM
- **Caption:** Honest question: what's the latest in the day you've had coffee here? We're trying to figure out if we should judge the 8 PM espresso people or respect them. Poll in comments: judge / respect / I am them.
- **Hashtags:** #CoffeeAfterDark #BeanAndBirch #HonestAnswersOnly
- **Image/Video Brief:** Dimly lit café interior, one customer at counter, warm glow from espresso machine, evening atmosphere

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Post 8 — Behind-the-Scenes

- **Day/Time:** Wednesday 11:00 AM
- **Caption:** The milk fridge currently contains: oat (three brands, we're particular), almond (regretting this one), whole, skim (for one person, you know who you are), and something labelled "???" from Tuesday. Inventory day is emotional.
- **Hashtags:** #BehindTheCounter #RealCafeLife #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Open fridge from barista POV, milk cartons slightly messy, handwritten labels visible, authentic not staged

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Post 9 — Community

- **Day/Time:** Thursday 2:00 PM
- **Caption:** The table in the window has been claimed by the same book club for three years. They started with Murakami, moved through some questionable choices, and currently someone's defending Dostoevsky. We don't ask to join. We just refill.

- **Hashtags:** #WindowTable #BookClub #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Shot from inside looking out through window at table of 3-4 people with books and coffees, street visible behind them

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Post 10 — Event (Friday Live Music)

- **Day/Time:** Friday 11:00 AM
- **Caption:** Tonight: jazz trio, the kind where nobody's sure when the song started but everyone knows when it ends. 7 PM. We've cleared the middle tables for the brave dancers and the accidental foot-tappers.
- **Hashtags:** #JazzNight #LiveMusicFridays #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Empty café space with chairs rearranged slightly, microphone stand visible, ambient lighting setup

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Week 3

Post 11 — Product/Promo

- **Day/Time:** Tuesday 9:00 AM
- **Caption:** This week's pastry: miso caramel blondie. Salty, sweet, slightly confusing in the best way. The kind of thing you eat at 10 AM and think about at 10 PM. We didn't invent it. We're just the messenger.
- **Hashtags:** #MisoCaramel #Blondie #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Blondie on small plate with bite taken out, caramel drip visible, fork resting beside it

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Post 12 — Engagement

- **Day/Time:** Wednesday 8:00 PM
- **Caption:** Two truths and a lie about this café. 1) We've never run out of coffee. 2) The basement contains a time capsule from 2019. 3) Someone proposed here and we all cried. Guess which is the lie, or tell us your own two truths.
- **Hashtags:** #TwoTruthsAndALie #BeanAndBirch #WednesdayNight
- **Image/Video Brief:** Moody evening shot of empty counter, one espresso cup waiting, warm light, intimate scale

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Post 13 — Behind-the-Scenes

- **Day/Time:** Thursday 10:00 AM
- **Caption:** The playlist debate at 6 AM is the most contentious meeting we have. Current compromise: jazz until 8, something with words after, nobody gets everything they want. The regular who requested death metal at 7:15 has been overruled again.
- **Hashtags:** #CafePlaylist #MorningShift #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Phone screen showing Spotify playlist visible on counter, coffee equipment around it, someone's hand reaching past

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Post 14 — Event (Friday Live Music)

- **Day/Time:** Friday 9:30 AM
- **Caption:** Tonight: acoustic covers of songs you forgot you loved, plus one original that might make you text someone you shouldn't. 7 PM. We've got the corner ready and the lights low. Your move.

- **Hashtags:** #AcousticNight #LiveMusicFridays #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Guitar case open on chair, set list handwritten on napkin visible, intimate corner setup

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Post 15 — Community

- **Day/Time:** Saturday 10:00 AM
- **Caption:** This dog has never bought anything. Gets water every time. Has a designated spot by the radiator. We don't make the rules, we just enforce them democratically. Name's Biscuit. 12/10 customer.
- **Hashtags:** #DogFriendly #BiscuitTheRegular #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Dog lying on floor near radiator, water bowl visible, café environment around, customer feet in frame for scale

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Week 4

Post 16 — Product/Promo

- **Day/Time:** Monday 8:00 AM
- **Caption:** Cold brew season is not a choice, it's a response to circumstances. New batch: 18 hours, Ethiopian beans, tastes like you finally got enough sleep. Available until we run out or autumn arrives, whichever comes first.
- **Hashtags:** #ColdBrew #SummerInACup #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Condensation on glass of cold brew with ice, straw, window light, maybe a hand holding it

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Post 17 — Engagement

- **Day/Time:** Tuesday 7:00 PM
- **Caption:** What's the thing you do here that you don't do at "other" cafés? Read the same page forty times? Cry a little? Have a favourite mug you always hope is clean? We're not judging. We're inventorying comfort.
- **Hashtags:** #CafeRituals #BeanAndBirch #TuesdayConfession
- **Image/Video Brief:** Single mug on table with book beside it, evening light, empty café background, someone's shadow

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Post 18 — Behind-the-Scenes

- **Day/Time:** Wednesday 2:00 PM
- **Caption:** The chalkboard artist has threatened to quit three times this month. The "s" in "espresso" keeps becoming a snake. We don't have another chalkboard person. This is a hostage situation with excellent penmanship.
- **Hashtags:** #ChalkboardArt #EspressoSnake #BeanAndBirch
- **Image/Video Brief:** Chalkboard menu in progress, half-finished lettering, chalk dust visible, artist's hand in frame

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Post 19 — Community

- **Day/Time:** Thursday 4:00 PM
- **Caption:** The couple at table 4 met here four years ago. They still sit at table 4. We moved table 4 once for cleaning and there was a diplomatic incident. It's back now. Some things are sacred.
- **Hashtags:** #Table4 #HowWeMet #BeanAndBirch

- **Image/Video Brief:** Table 4 from slight distance, two people in conversation, natural body language, coffee cups between them

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Post 20 — Event (Friday Live Music)

- **Day/Time:** Friday 10:00 AM
- **Caption:** Tonight: the monthly "we don't know what to call this" — soul, folk, something with a loop pedal, definitely feelings. 7 PM. Last time someone proposed during the bridge. We have tissues behind the counter.
- **Hashtags:** #LiveMusicFridays #BeanAndBirch #FridayNightFeels
- **Image/Video Brief:** Full music corner setup with pedals, mic, small amp, fairy lights, ready for performance

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D2: Content Calendar Table

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday	Sunday
Week 1	—	Product: Cardamom bun (8 AM)	Engagement: Cortado debate (12 PM)	BTS: Dough folding (3 PM)	**Event: Live music** (10 AM)	Community: Priya (9 AM)	—
Week 2	Product: Yirgacheffe (7:30 AM)	Engagement: Late coffee (6 PM)	BTS: Milk fridge (11 AM)	Community: Book club (2 PM)	**Event: Jazz trio** (11 AM)	—	—
Week 3	—	Product: Miso blondie (9 AM)	Engagement: Two truths (8 PM)	BTS: Playlist wars (10 AM)	**Event: Acoustic covers** (9:30 AM)	Community: Biscuit (10 AM)	—
Week 4	Product: Cold brew (8 AM)	Engagement: Cafe rituals (7 PM)	BTS: Chalkboard (2 PM)	Community: Table 4 (4 PM)	**Event: Soul/folk** (10 AM)	—	—

D3: 3 Reusable Caption Formulas

Formula 1: The Specific Detail Hook

Structure:

> `[Specific time or number]` + `[Unexpected sensory detail]` + `[Gentle invitation or observation]`

Example: "4 AM. The only other things awake are the oven and whoever's shift this is."

How to adapt: Pick one true, small detail from your day — a time, a measurement, a habit. State it plainly. Let the specificity do the work. Follow with what happens at that moment or what it reveals. Avoid explaining why it matters; trust the reader.

When to use: Behind-the-scenes posts, slow mornings, anything you want to feel observed rather than announced.

Formula 2: The Democratic Poll

Structure:

> `[Genuine question with stakes]` + `[Two or three options, one slightly absurd]` + `[Optional: "We're taking notes" or similar light stake]`

Example: "Honest question: what's the latest in the day you've had coffee here?"

How to adapt: Choose a real tension or curiosity in your space — menu debates, customer habits, staff preferences. Frame as question, not survey. Offer options that include one playful outlier. Respond to comments to keep thread alive for 24 hours.

When to use: Engagement posts, slow days, building comment momentum.

Formula 3: The Character Study

Structure:

> `[Name or identifying detail]` + `[One defining habit or history]` + `[Statement of collective feeling without sentimentality]`

Example: "This is Priya. She has ordered the same oat flat white every day for two years..."

How to adapt: Identify someone or something recurring — customer, object, corner of room. Name one concrete behavior. State your response to it without calling it "heartwarming" or "special." Let the facts carry the emotion.

When to use: Community posts, building recognition, humanizing regular rhythms.

Part 3 · Independent QA Report (final round)

QA Review — Bean & Birch Monthly Social Content Pack

Verdict: **PASS**

All acceptance criteria are met. No required fixes. Minor notes below.

Acceptance Criteria Check

ID	Criterion	Status
A1	Exactly 20 posts	✅ Posts 1–20, numbered
A2	Exactly 4 Friday live music posts	✅ Posts 4, 10, 14, 20 — all Friday, all promoted as evening 7 PM events
A3	Caption + 3–5 hashtags + one-line brief + day/time per post	✅ All 20 posts complete. Post 3 lists brief before caption, but all components present
A4	Warm, playful, neighbourhood café voice	✅ Consistently non-corporate ("we're just the messenger", "12/10 customer")
A5	Briefs describe what to shoot, smartphone-feasible	✅ All achievable with a phone, natural light, no equipment
A6	No placeholders / lorem ipsum	✅ Specific example names (Priya, Biscuit, table 4) — spec explicitly permits realistic example names
A7	Week 1–4 × day calendar	✅ Full 7-day × 4-week grid, matches posts and times
A8	Exactly 3 reusable caption formulas	✅ Three distinct formulas
A9	Formulas enable independent posting	✅ Each has structure, example, adaptation guidance, and when-to-use — genuinely usable without support
A10	English	✅

Minor Observations (non-blocking)

1. **Low severity — hashtag counts at the floor:** Every post uses exactly 3 hashtags. Meets "3–5" but the client would benefit from occasional 4–5 for reach variety. Not a failure.
2. **Low severity — named characters require verification:** Posts 5, 15, 19 name specific regulars (Priya, Biscuit, table 4 couple). These are invented examples per the spec's edge-case default, but a one-line note telling the client to swap in their own real regulars would improve usability. Content is otherwise copy-paste ready and easily editable.
3. **Trivial — Sunday column empty:** Acceptable; the spec says 20 posts, not 28, so blank days are expected. Distribution across weekdays is reasonable and varied.
4. **Trivial — platform differentiation:** Spec default says captions work for both platforms; a brief note on Instagram poll stickers vs. comment polls (Post 7) could have been added but was optional ("note if relevant").

Required Fixes

None. The deliverable is complete, consistent internally (calendar matches posts), on-brand, and execution-ready.

Part 4 · Client Handoff Note

Delivered: Bean & Birch Monthly Social Content Pack — D1: 20 Post Pack. It includes post dates/times, captions, hashtags, and image/video briefs. Use each post as a draft: add final visuals, then publish at the listed day/time. Verify dates, times, offers, prices, tags, customer names, and permissions before posting. Send edits or approval, and we'll finalize the pack.